

as four finger swipe to toggle apps or five finger pinch to close apps. The iPad shook up the world of casual computing with its clever design and almost intuitive ease of use.

Striving for perfection, Apple brought out the iPad 2 and now the third generation iPad. A camera was missing in the original gadget and was included on the front and rear in its next models. The third generation model looked almost exactly like the iPad 2 retaining the same glass and aluminum construction and same dimensions, the same home button and volume rocker on the right side, but as soon as you switch on the screen, the magic begins. Apple reset the standards of display when it introduced the Retina display in its iPhone 4, and the new iPad brings the same experience onto your tablet screen as well. The model's 2048-by-1536 pixel, 9.7-inch display successfully sets another standard for all coming tablets to match. The text is crisp, images are sharp and quality videos can be seen just the way they were meant to, all that's missing are newer, improved apps to catch upto the amazing display. Apple even partially included Siri in its latest iPad edition.

But the biggest thing the iPad can be credited for is heralding an era where people carry smart phones, have tiny music players in their pockets, work on their laptops and desktops as much as before, and yet somehow find use for a device combining all the above. When many critics shouted their doubts out loud as to who would buy the iPad when you already have an iPhone and an iPod around, Apple just went ahead and gave us another smart product that harmoniously blended into our digital lives and opened up the gates to many more manufacturers hoping to recreate if not replace the same experience. Tablets made users more accommodating in a way that tablets started finding permanent places outside a geek's desk. There are now classrooms which teach students on iPads instead of pen and paper, musicians are making melodies while on the move, writers and authors alike are enjoying the freedom of ditching bulky volumes and adopting digital book shelves; from cooking recipes to beauty tips, everything is out there for us on this one tiny tablet, no wonder the trend is catching on. The popularity of iPhone and iPad has once and for all answered the question that the touch screen is not just a passing fad, but a digital trend that is here to stay.

The UI might be Apple's forte, but with open source Android looming large, would being a closed system prove to be its Achilles heels? Apple so far successfully controls the entire ecosystem of its products, the software,